

P R E F A C E

It is so easy for an English-speaking person to learn Spanish. Through Latin, both languages stem from a common root and share "a lingual ancestry." Indeed, there are so many similarities between the two languages that some people describe them as "language cousins." Thousands of words in Spanish are similar to or identical with their English equivalents; and a great many words sound almost alike. Then, too, Spanish pronunciation is easier. It is straightforward, without any of the "exceptions" that occur in English.

The approach here is progressive. From the very beginning, the student is on familiar ground. Many words that are in common use in both languages, that look and sound alike, and that relate to ordinary, everyday situations are used. On so firm a beginning, the student can, with confidence, proceed to more complex sentences. With every step forward he can add to his vocabulary and develop his verbal facility.

Anyone who has ever tried to learn a language by the laborious route of memorizing complex grammar rules, and has had to struggle with the numerous exceptions to these rules, will be pleasantly surprised at how easy it is to learn Spanish with the method used in this book.

Nothing, of course, is done without effort. Nevertheless, with the help of a few simple steps conscientiously followed, learning Spanish can be a pleasure. The method here followed makes the student want to learn. Before he has gone very far, before he is even aware of it, he will be speaking Spanish. And he will love it.

A unique feature of this book is that each page contains one lesson by itself. Physically, this arrangement makes it easier to work with and to use the book. From the teaching and learning point of view, it is an arrangement that presents each lesson as a separate and complete unit, allowing for quicker and more direct reference.

A Few Suggestions

For the Student.—The words and phrases that head each lesson are those to be studied in that lesson. Familiarize yourself with them. When you think you know them, read the rest of the lesson and study it.

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